

r/vegan

I Was Concerned About AI Water Use But This is Worse

Posted by u/MWisecarver • 0 points • 10 comments

Man he's good at this. The data is shocking of course.

Comments

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2026-01-18 14:50 UTC

[removed]

u/donut-meow • 1 points • 2025-08-11 17:14 UTC

I wish videos like these were more popular... I want to show my friends but I guarantee they'd be a bit irked even though they already don't like AI

u/MWisecarver • 2 points • 2025-08-11 17:21 UTC

Saw news report recently that the main *anti* AI activity is here on r/philosophy/

u/danielandrent • 6 points • 2025-08-07 11:03 UTC

The people avoiding AI for “environmental reasons” are just embarrassing

The only reason they're avoiding it is because they don't like it in the first place, if it was something like “tasty bacon” that used that much water, would they care? Would they avoid it? No, they wouldn't, and they don't

u/ShadowAze • 1 points • 2025-08-20 08:41 UTC

Maybe instead of putting people down, you should use it as a springboard to enlighten people about the impacts of the meat industry (and in general, just inefficient farming).

While not a guarantee, people are more likely to join your cause if you are being nice to them and encouraging instead of not doing that.

Because I guarantee you that people don't like AI for ethical reasons, not primarily environmental, it's part of it but not a major reason (besides, we've only seen a small piece of the impact, that industry is going to get a lot of investments and it's only going to get worse). Shaming people for the environmental aspects will be seen as being shamed for ethical aspects.

u/hippopotapistachio • 1 points • 2025-08-12 22:58 UTC

can't say I agree!

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2025-08-07 15:13 UTC

[removed]

u/Mauricio_ehpotatoman • 1 points • 2025-08-07 15:07 UTC

You can still be a vegan and hate AI ruining the internet and environment. What's your problem?

u/best-unaccompanied • 5 points • 2025-08-07 03:22 UTC

This is why I oppose (most generative) AI for ethical reasons, not environmental

u/JTexpo • 3 points • 2025-08-06 23:11 UTC

Love mics content

u/Shmackback • 36 points • 2025-08-06 22:35 UTC

If tldw; 132000 ai searches equals 1 beef burger in water usage.

u/TaDoofus • 1 points • 2025-08-07 23:40 UTC

Individual prompts to an AI doesn't use that many resources, the power dump goes into training the models.

u/inabahare • 8 points • 2025-08-07 06:13 UTC

Because it's one of the many many things that make AI shit. And we can (and should) complain about both

u/Popular_Dirt_1154 • 1 points • 2025-08-07 01:39 UTC

Where do you get your numbers? People just make it up and say ai doesn't use that much but has any ai company openly disclosed this data to make an accurate graph? I have seen independent people try and create this data but it is untrustworthy, how can you compare simple prompt energy usage to deep research prompt compute?

u/1389t1389 • 20 points • 2025-08-06 23:30 UTC

AI is an easy target when it sucks in other ways too and most people already don't use it, compared to the personal inconvenience to them from reckoning with their food choices.

u/Popular_Dirt_1154 • 2 points • 2025-08-07 01:55 UTC

We are just in the beginning and with investments like Trumps \$500b to Altman it will only continue to increase drastically. Houston Advanced Research centre released a paper to Austin Chronicle saying water use from data centres (not just ai) in Texas will 49b gallons by the end of 2025, 399b yearly by 2030 with predicated rates of increase, 7% of all Texas water usage. Add in climate change increased drought frequency and intensity and it's a bit ridiculous this is where all our money is being funneled into.

u/1389t1389 • 2 points • 2025-08-07 12:16 UTC

The most egregious overuse of water in the US is alfalfa in Utah from animal agriculture subsidies, but yeah, these data centers are bad news. Even besides water, Memphis is being choked to death with toxic fumes (environmental racism in action) to fuel Grok.

The AI bubble will burst, though. It's been far overblown, and most consumers are actually repulsed by it in advertising, some studies have shown.